

NUMERICAL ANALYSIS PROBLEM SET 2

ROB TOMPKINS

We begin by noting that all of the files referenced in this document are available at:
<https://github.com/chtompki/MathSpring2026/tree/main/NumericalAnalysis/ProblemSet2>

1. Use the command `magic(n)`, for $n = 100, 200, 300, \dots, 10^4$ to construct the magic square matrices of order n . Magic squares are defined as those matrices having entries for which the sum of the elements by rows, columns, or diagonals are identical. Then compute their determinants by the command `det()`. Use the command `cputime` to get the CPU time that is needed for this computation. **Be patient, it may take around 10 minutes to compute these determinants.**

Find a constant C such that the computation time t_n scales approximately as $t_n Cn^3$. Plot your data and approximate scaling using `semilogy()`. Think back to the methods you learned for computing determinants in your Linear Algebra class. What method do you suspect Matlab is using and why? How can you be sure it isn't using cofactor expansion?

Solution. We begin by noticing that for any $A = \text{magic}(n)$ where n is even, $\det(A) = 0$. So we are less concerned with keeping the value of the determinants, and are more interested in the number of seconds that it takes to calculate the i^{th} -determinant. A sample of the code (given in file `ps2prob1.m`) that we are using follows as:

```
determinants=zeros(1,100);
cpuTime=zeros(1,100);
for n=100:100:10000
    A = magic(n);
    tstart = cputime;
    det(A);
    cpuTime(n/100) = cputime - tstart;
end
plotN=1:100;
figure;hold on; semilogyi(plotN, 0.000008.*plotN.^3, '--x', plotN, cpuTime, '-x');
xlabel('Matrix Size (n/100)');
ylabel('Value');
```

Date: February 20, 2026.

```

legend('Cn^3','CpuTime');
title('Determinants and CPU Time vs. Matrix Size');

```

Notice that around the determinant calculation we are taking the system time and doing a subtraction to get the duration of the determinant algorithm. The figure that we get from plotting the cputime follows in Figure 1. Lastly we notice that for $C = 2.5 \times 10^{-5}$, which we

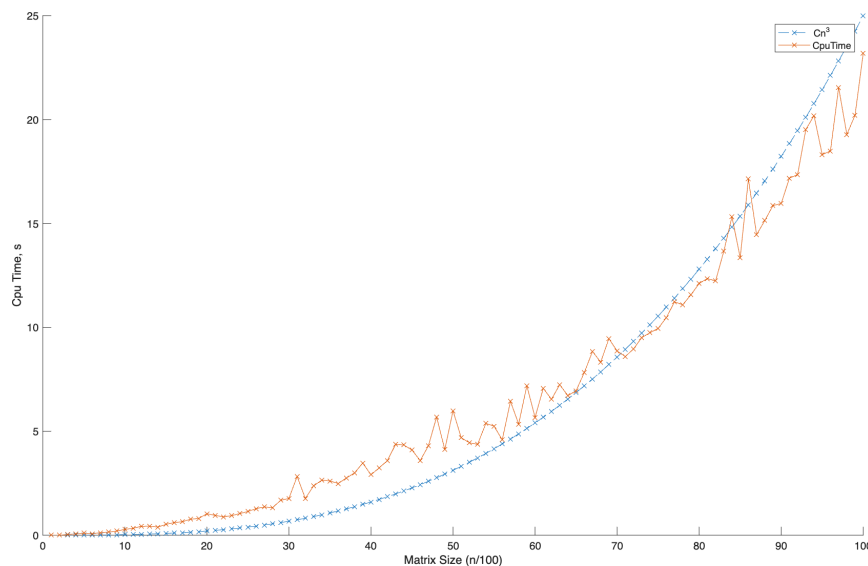


FIGURE 1. Determinant Runtime by Matrix Size

found by fiddling around with the algorithm to get the value using the bisection method by hand so to speak. $\square$

2. Consider the matrix $A = \begin{pmatrix} 201 & 199 \\ 199 & 201 \end{pmatrix}$.

- Compute the spectral radius of $\rho(A)$.
- Compute the condition number $K(A)$. You may choose any natural matrix norm, but be sure to specify which one you are using.
- Assume some numerical method has been applied to obtain the approximate solution $\hat{x} = (-0.5, 0.5)^\top$ to the system $Ax = B$ for $b = (-2, 2)^\top$. Use the residual $r = A\hat{x} - b$ and known inequalities to provide a bound on the norm of the relative error $\frac{\|\hat{x} - x\|}{\|x\|}$.
- Find the exact solution to the above system (you may use any method you prefer, but show your work)., Compare the relative error estimate from above to the actual relative error.
- In general, when can you expect the residual r to provide a tight bound on the error?

Solution. For the problem generally we'll use the L_2 -norm.

(a) To compute the spectral radius $\rho(A)$, we go after the eigenvalues of A . So, let's compute the characteristic polynomial.

$$p(t) = \begin{vmatrix} 201 - t & 199 \\ 199 & 201 - t \end{vmatrix} = t^2 - 402t - 40401 - 39601 = t^2 - 402t + 800.$$

So we solve for $p(t) = 0$, and we get the following roots λ_1, λ_2 from the quadratic formula:

$$\lambda_1, \lambda_2 = \frac{402 \pm \sqrt{161604 - 3200}}{2} = \frac{402 \pm 398}{2} = 2, 400.$$

So for (a), our spectral radius follows as:

$$\rho(A) = \max\{\lambda_1, \lambda_2\} = 400.$$

(b) We'll continue to use the L_2 -norm here. Notice that $A \in \text{symm}(\mathbb{R})$, so we know that the eigenvalues λ_1, λ_2 set up as:

$$\|A\|_2 = 400 \quad \text{and} \quad \|A^{-1}\|_2 = \frac{1}{2}.$$

So by definition of $K(A)$, we have

$$K_2(A) = \|A\|_2 \|A^{-1}\|_2 = \frac{400}{2} = 200.$$

(c) We start with some matrix multiplication to see what our vectors $\hat{x}, b$ from the problem statement give us. So we see that

$$\begin{bmatrix} 201 & 199 \\ 199 & 201 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} -0.5 \\ 0.5 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 201(-0.5) + 199(0.5) \\ 199(-0.5) + 201(0.5) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

So write the residual as

$$r = A\hat{x} - b = \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} - \begin{bmatrix} -2 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

So we let the error be $e = \hat{x} - x$. Notice

$$r = A\hat{x} - b = A\hat{x} - Ax = A(\hat{x} - x) = Ae.$$

We can use our condition number theorem for this bit of the problem now where we notice that

$$\frac{\|e\|}{\|x\|} \leq K(A) \frac{\|r\|}{\|b\|}.$$

We already have $K(A)$, so we only need calculate $\|r\|/\|b\|$. But we can do a quick calculation on those values as:

$$\|r\| = \sqrt{1^2 + (-1)^2} = \sqrt{2} \quad \text{and} \quad \|b\| = \sqrt{(2)^2 + (-2)^2} = 2\sqrt{2}$$

So we have that

$$\frac{\|\hat{x} - x\|}{\|x\|} \leq 200 \cdot \frac{1}{2} = 100.$$

(d) If we compute the actual error what do we get? Begin by noticing that

$$e = \hat{x} - x = \begin{bmatrix} -0.5 \\ 0.5 \end{bmatrix} - \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.5 \\ -0.5 \end{bmatrix}$$

So we can simply now compute $\|e\| = 1/\sqrt{2}$, and $\|x\| = \sqrt{2}$, so the actual error is

$$\frac{\|\hat{x} - x\|}{\|x\|} = \frac{1}{2}$$

(e) We go back to our theorem:

$$\frac{\|e\|}{\|x\|} \leq K(A) \frac{\|r\|}{\|b\|}.$$

For our bound to be tight, we need the inequalities above to be close to equalities. And for these equalities to be close we need that $K(A)$ be well conditioned and $\|r\|/\|b\|$

□

3. Consider the linear system $Ax = b$ with

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -2 & 0 \\ \epsilon - 2 & 2 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$$

- (a) Compute the LU factorization of the given A by hand using Gaussian Elimination, and show that the matrix L has the element $\ell_{32} = -1/\epsilon$.
- (b) Compute the LU factorization by hand using the Crout algorithm, and show the matrix L has the element $\ell_{22} = \epsilon$ in this case.
- (c) Compute the condition number $K(A)$. You may use any norm you like, but be sure to specify which one you use.
- (d) Multiply Ax for $x = [111]^\top$ to find the corresponding b for which $x = [111]^\top$ is a solution to $Ax = b$. Your answer should depend upon ϵ . For values $\epsilon = 10^{-k}$, with $k = 0, \dots, 9$ numerically implement the Crout method of LU decomposition to solve the system $Ax = b$. Compute the relative error as a function of ϵ . Compare your results based on the Crout algorithm to results obtained using the build in `lu(A)` function.
- (e) Repeat the process above for $x = [\log(2.5) \ 1 \ 1]^\top$ for values $\epsilon = 1/3 \times 10^{-k}$, $k = 0, \dots, 9$. Compare the relative error for this choice of b to the previous case. Why didn't you see the impact of roundoff error in the previous case, but you do in this

case? Discuss your numerical error results for this case in the context of theoretical error estimates based on your computation of the condition number $K(A)$.

Solution. (a) We begin by assuming that r_1 , r_2 , and r_3 are the rows of the augmented matrix below.

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 2 & -2 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ \epsilon - 2 & 2 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

Perform the row operation $r_2 : (-\epsilon/2 + 1)r_1 + r_2$, where “.” denotes replacement, seen as follows

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 2 & -2 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & \epsilon & 0 & \frac{-\epsilon}{2} + 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

Let's now get rid of ϵ on the left hand side of our matrix by the row substitution $r_2 : r_2/\epsilon$, giving us

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 2 & -2 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & \frac{-1}{2} + \frac{1}{\epsilon} & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

Let's now look at making the leading entry in the matrix one, by $r_1 : r_1/2$ as:

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & -1 & 0 & \frac{1}{2} & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & \frac{-1}{2} + \frac{1}{\epsilon} & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right].$$

Perform $r_1 : r_2 + r_1$ as

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & 0 & 0 & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & \frac{-1}{2} + \frac{1}{\epsilon} & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 3 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right].$$

Similarly, perform $r_3 : r_2 + r_3$ given by

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & 0 & 0 & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & \frac{-1}{2} + \frac{1}{\epsilon} & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 & -\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{\epsilon} & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & 1 \end{array} \right].$$

Lastly perform $r_3 : r_3/3$ as:

$$\left[\begin{array}{ccc|ccc} 1 & 0 & 0 & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & \frac{-1}{2} + \frac{1}{\epsilon} & \frac{1}{\epsilon} & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & -\frac{1}{6} + \frac{1}{3\epsilon} & \frac{1}{3\epsilon} & \frac{1}{3} \end{array} \right].$$

Well dang it, I wrote all that out and I know that it's not LU decomposition. We'll have another go, but I didn't want to erase that work either.

□

4. Consider the matrix as follows

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 + 0.5 \times 10^{-15} & 3 \\ 2 & 2 & 20 \\ 3 & 6 & 4 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Compute the LU decomposition by Crout's method (without pivoting). You may carry out the procedure in Matlab, but show your code and the output after iterating through each stage. Compute the residual $R = A - LU$. Compare the result to the residual for LUP decomposition obtained with pivoting by using the Matlab command `[L U] = lu(A)` and computing $R_P = PA - LU$.

Solution. sol

□

5. Consider the following matrix:

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 - \epsilon & 3 \\ 2 & 2 & 2 \\ 3 & 6 & 4 \end{bmatrix}.$$

- (a) Find the values of ϵ for which LU decomposition (without pivoting) is not possible.
- (b) Find the LU decomposition for the value of ϵ for which A is singular.
- (c) What in the LU decomposition signals that A is singular for this case?

Solution.

□

6. Show that for a symmetric positive definite matrix A we have $K_2(A^2) = (K_2(A))^2$.

Hint. Make use of the relation between the minimum and maximum eigenvalues $\lambda_{\min}, \lambda_{\max}$ and condition number $K_2(A)$ associated to the L^2 natural matrix norm for a symmetric positive definite matrix A .

Proof.

□

7. Prove that the following are symmetric positive definite matrices. Implement the Cholesky decomposition algorithm and use it to compute the Cholesky decomposition for each.

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 16 & -28 & 0 \\ -28 & 53 & 10 \\ 0 & 10 & 29 \end{bmatrix}, \quad B = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & 3 & -2 \\ -2 & 20 & -2 & 8 \\ 3 & -2 & 11 & -5 \\ -2 & 8 & -5 & 9 \end{bmatrix}.$$